

Group Contract Requirement for Groups of 2 or More Students

Introduction

Students working in a group should submit a group contract with their proposal. This document details the requirements and elements of the group contract.

Provide a separate document titled **Group Contract** with the following information. All student members are expected to upload the same contract as a form of acknowledgment that every student has read and understood the terms of the group contract.

The group contract should include the following sections:

- **Contact information section:** group names, emails, and phone numbers or other contact information.
- **Group meetings section:** see below.
- **Tasks section:** see below.

Submit the group contract with your proposal.

Group meetings section

The goal of this section is to provide some ground rules for productive meetings. The minimum requirements for this section include:

- **Preferred mode of communication:** Students should be able to setup times via email and/or confirm via text messages. Specify your preferred mode of communication among group members.
- **Missing meeting policy:** When a student cannot make a meeting, they should notify the entire team and get updates on the meeting. Provide a brief paragraph that explains your policy for missing meetings.
- **Duration statement:** Provide the expected minimum and maximum number of times for each meeting in hours.
- **Scheduled Meetings Timeline:** Provide a schedule for your meetings. It should indicate the number of times, durations, and where (e.g., online or in-person).
- **Respectful meetings:** During meetings, group members are expected to be respectful to each other, take turns, and appreciate different views. Provide a brief paragraph for your approach to ensure respectful meetings.
- **Additional ground rules:** Please add any additional rules for your group meetings. If there are no additional rules, please enter None.

Tasks section

This section aims to provide guidelines for an equitable distribution of tasks among group members. Its goal is to replace traditional guidelines based on writing assignments that are not representative of Machine Learning and Data Science projects, where most of the work concerns coding.

All students are expected to contribute equitably to the writing and coding:

- **Select a coding task:** see below for examples of equitable coding tasks.
- **Documenting the task within the final document**

Students should contribute the following to the final document:

- **Conduct literature review:** The goal is to provide precise information about each task.
- **Code Description for task:** the goal is to provide a pseudocode or flowchart describing the process. If the amount of code is small, students are expected to provide the code in the Appendix.
- **Code usage:** The code interface must be sufficiently documented so another group member can use it. This includes examples of how to set up a dataset, run the code, etc.
- **Code sharing:** Code should be shared among group members using *GitHub*, *Google Drive*, or *Dropbox*. GitHub sharing is best but not required since it requires making your code openly available.
- **Innovation for task:** Describe what was actually done, how it is different from what was previously done, and why changes had to be taken.

Examples of **equitable coding tasks include:**

- **Dataset creation:** This covers data collection, data loaders, and the training, validation, and testing split.
- **Model(s):** Student members can develop different models or modify existing models. Modifying existing models can be more difficult than creating new models from scratch.
- **Model training, validation, and testing:** This task covers setting learning rates, epochs, selecting the optimization algorithm, etc.

The **minimum requirements** for this section include:

- **Task primary member table:** Students should submit a table providing the primary member for each task. An example table entry is `Dataset Creation: Marios`.
- **Task collaboration table:** Coding requires collaboration. Later coding tasks require the completion of earlier tasks. This table should list all of the tasks along its rows and all of the group members among the columns. The primary members assigned

to each task should have a checkmark for their assigned task. Other checkmarks indicate that the primary member should collaborate closely to complete the tasks.

- **Task schedule table:** This table should include all tasks along the rows and approximate start and end dates for each task.
- **Equitable task distribution statement:** Provide a short statement explaining why you believe you have divided the work equally. For example, you can provide the approximate number of hours required for each task and a brief description of how you reached your estimate. Make sure to allocate time to support each other. Of course, if something goes wrong, you are expected to support each other.